

practically equally valuable properties on the highways of the internet. Contrast the following tasks, given that you are to start with nothing: trying to open a hotel that is even remotely comparable to [insert high end hotel chain here]; and opening a website that is a streamlined and better featured version of [insert popular website here]. If you are determined enough, with this Fast Track you could achieve the second task in a matter of weeks! In less than 24 hours even, if you're that kind of genius who naturally appears to be on NZT-48. Of course, we did say almost perfectly flat. Which was to stress on the fact that it is NOT a level playing ground, unfair advantages do exist. Other than sites that have already made a mark in our minds (like Google), the prime differentiator between websites are the number of highways that link to them. These links come from search engines and other websites, as we saw in detail in last month's Fast Track to Search Engine Optimization, and as we will briefly see in forthcoming chapters. As far as content is concerned, unless you're hosting gigabytes of video (which is still freely stored on YouTube), storage is cheap. Domain registration is cheaper still, unless you want a really common word which is a premium domain (which is why many new companies have names that spell like typos). Overall, other than the effort and expertise, owning a web domain is a highly affordable (and did we mention potentially profitable?) affair. So unless you're an anxious loner by choice, get your website up already!

Of course, you could always pay someone else to do it for you, but that is a much larger investment than it needs to be, until you're dealing with six digits. That's about the number (cost and/or traffic) when hiring a professional specialist can make a significant difference. With high traffic volumes (like Amazon level high volume), even a single word from the content can affect a big chunk of revenue. For the purposes of the above average Digit reader (because all Digit readers are above average), the investment in this month's magazine should be enough. Well, if you want a website with your own domain name (like www.yourname.com), it will cost you some more, say, another magazine. That is still less than quarter the cost of hiring the lowest wage web developer. Now that you hold this Fast Track in your hands, the first step has been taken, your website is in the making.

“What to build?”, that is the question!

To have a clear idea of what you want to build, you first need to decide on why you are building in the first place. Are you expanding the accessibility of your business? Are you showcasing your skills and work to enhance your